

In the `auto.master` map, I have changed the base mount folder from `/home` to `/home/userhome`, as I would now like to have this as the base mounting folder.

The important change is in the `/etc/auto.home` map =>

```
[root@rdso ~]# cat /etc/auto.home
*
    -rw      192.168.122.1:/myusersdata/&
[root@rdso ~]#
```

We need to take a deeper look at the changes:

- i) Instead of a fixed local mountpoint, now the mountpoint is specified by the wildcard character «*»
- ii) Instead of a fixed remote filesystem name, the path of the remote filesystem ends with «&»

What this does is, whenever the system accesses any («*» in `/etc/auto.home`) folder in `/home/userhome`, e.g., `/home/userhome/vbg1`, this folder gets mounted from the remote path (`192.168.122.1:/myusersdata/vbg` - specified by the trailing «&»). In other words, if I access folder `/home/userhome/lfy`, then the automounter will try to mount `192.168.122.1/myusersdata/lfy` at `/home/userhome/lfy`.

Make the above changes and restart the autofs service. If you are now able to log in as user `vbg1`, the differences are obvious:

```
[root@rdso ~]# /etc/init.d/autofs restart
Stopping autmount: [ OK ]
Starting autmount: [ OK ]
[root@rdso ~]# su - vbg1
```

To check the mountpoints:

```
[vbg1@rdso ~]$ df -h
Filesystem                Size  Used Avail Use% Mounted on
/dev/mapper/VolGroup00-LogVol00
                        8.0G  5.3G  3.0G   64% /
/dev/hda1                  99M   13M   82M   14% /boot
tmpfs                     250M    0 250M    0% /dev/shm
192.168.122.1:/myusersdata/vbg1
                        19G  17G  1.6G   92% /home/userhome/vbg1
```

Wow! Only `/myusersdata/vbg1` has been mounted -- this is what we need.

```
[vbg1@rdso ~]$ ls -l /home/userhome/
total 4

drwxrwxrwx 3 root root 4096 Oct 21 06:46 vbg1
[vbg1@rdso ~]$
```

Therefore, we see that auto-mounter really helps in establishing roaming profiles for centrally authenticated environments. The major management bottleneck here is that these files (`/etc/auto/master` and `/etc/auto.home`) need to be created in every system. Once again, LDAP comes to

the rescue. You can store the automount maps information in the directory. As usual, the logical flow of steps required to accomplish this would be as follows:

- a) Create the necessary `ldif` files
- b) Ensure that the required schema files are present
- c) Import the `ldif` files in the directory
- d) Make changes in the client to read autofs information from LDAP rather than files (`/etc/auto/master`)
- e) Log in and test

We will again use the 'very useful' migration tool to create the `ldif` files. For this, we will copy the map files from the client to the OpenLDAP server and run the migration scripts =>

```
[root@vbg migration]# scp 192.168.122.82:/etc/auto.master /tmp
root@192.168.122.82's password:
auto.master
100% 748 0.7KB/s 00:00
[root@vbg migration]# scp 192.168.122.82:/etc/auto.home /tmp
root@192.168.122.82's password:
auto.home
100% 36 0.0KB/s 00:00
[root@vbg migration]# pwd
/usr/share/openldap/migration
[root@vbg migration]# ./migrate_automount.pl /tmp/auto.master > /tmp/autol.ldif
[root@vbg migration]# ./migrate_automount.pl /tmp/auto.home > /tmp/autol.ldif
```

In the next article of the series, we will have a detailed look at these files. We need to make minor adjustments in our `ldif` files. I have combined the two files `/tmp/autol.ldif` and `/tmp/autol2.ldif` to create a single file `/tmp/autol.ldif`, that looks like what's given below:

```
[root@vbg migration]# cat /tmp/autol.ldif
dn: nisMapName=auto.master,dc=knaifi,dc=org
objectClass: top
objectClass: nisMap
nisMapName: auto.master

dn: cn=/home/userhome,nisMapName=auto.master,dc=knaifi,dc=org
objectClass: nisObject
cn: /home/userhome
nisMapEntry: auto.home
nisMapName: auto.master

dn: nisMapName=auto.home,dc=knaifi,dc=org
objectClass: top
objectClass: nisMap
nisMapName: auto.home

dn: cn=*,nisMapName=auto.home,dc=knaifi,dc=org
objectClass: nisObject
cn: *
nisMapEntry: -rw      192.168.122.1:/myusersdata/&
```